



GAS ON A HIGH

The escalation of domestic gas prices (62 per cent last October and 110 per cent in April) could nix India's plans to double the share of gas in its energy mix. It has also prompted city gas distribution (CGD) companies to demand an increase in supply of cheaper gas from onshore fields under the administered price mechanism.

—MANISH PANT

FAB PUSH SPEEDING UP

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology is interviewing candidates for the head of its India Semiconductor Mission (ISM). The CEO of this independent business division will drive India's strategies for developing semiconductor and the display manufacturing ecosystem, negotiating with the applicants for appropriate technology mix, node size(s), capacity, etc. Industry sources told *Business Today* that MeitY has short-listed about 35 candidates—established names of the semiconductor industry from India and abroad—who are being interviewed for the position. In addition, the Semicon India 2022 conference will be held on April 29 in Bengaluru, which will feature several global industry leaders.

—NIDHI SINGAL



KGF's Moolah Ride

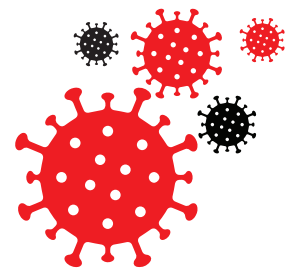
THE CHANGING PHASE of Bollywood is now getting increasingly obvious with the success of movies from the South turning out to be big money-spinners in Hindi. After the dubbed versions of *Bahubali*, *Pushpa*, and *RRR* striking it big, it is now the turn of *KGF: Chapter 2*. Made on a budget of ₹100 crore, it has already raked in over ₹900 crore in the domestic market, of which the Hindi version's share alone is ₹300 crore. It has taken just seven days to hit the mark and, in the process, has eclipsed other big Hindi movie releases. Whoever said cinema cannot travel across regions?

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

COVID-19: NUMBERS RISING

After witnessing a sustained decline, Covid-19 cases are climbing again. Once schools fully reopened and Covid precautions were relaxed, states such as Delhi, Maharashtra, Haryana, Mizoram and Uttar Pradesh have seen a spike in infections, pushing the national daily tally to more than 2,500.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA



| 15

HIRING BOOM FOR FRESHERS IN IT

Fresher hiring is likely to be robust this year, too. IT companies, dragged down by all-time-high attrition rates and a raging talent war because of poaching employees from each other, are looking to increase the IT talent supply. IT bellwethers TCS and Infosys, which

reported 17.4 per cent and 27.7 per cent attrition as of March 31, 2022, have said they will hire at least 40,000 and 50,000 freshers, respectively, in FY23. The focus is also on how companies can cut down the time taken to train and deploy them quickly.

—VIDYA S.



LAKH CRORE AMOUNT SPENT BY THE GOVERNMENT ON SOCIAL SECTOR PROGRAMMES AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT OVER THE PAST EIGHT YEARS